



Incident handler's journal

Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this journal as a way to log the key takeaways about the different cybersecurity tools or concepts you encounter in this course.

Date: 2026/05/03	Entry: 1
Description	A U.S. healthcare clinic experienced a ransomware attack on a Tuesday morning that disrupted business operations. The attack originated from a phishing email containing a malicious attachment, which, once opened, installed malware and encrypted critical system files.
Tool(s) used	Phishing email, malicious attachment, ransomware (encryption malware)
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. ● Who caused the incident? The incident was caused by an organized group of cybercriminals who specialize in targeting healthcare and transportation organizations using ransomware attacks. ● What happened? Employees received phishing emails with malicious attachments. Once opened, the malware installed ransomware that encrypted critical files, making systems and patient records inaccessible. ● When did the incident occur?

	The incident occurred on a Tuesday at approximately 9:00 a.m., during normal business hours. • Where did the incident happen? The incident occurred within the clinic's internal network and affected employee workstations and systems used to access medical records. • Why did the incident happen? The incident happened because employees were targeted by phishing emails and unknowingly downloaded malicious attachments, allowing attackers to gain access and deploy ransomware.
Additional notes	This incident highlights the importance of employee cybersecurity awareness training, especially in recognizing phishing attempts. It also raises questions about whether the organization had email filtering, endpoint protection, or data backups in place to mitigate such attacks.

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	• Why did the incident happen?
Additional notes	Include any additional thoughts, questions, or findings.

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Need another journal entry template?

If you want to add more journal entries, please copy one of the tables above and paste it into the template to use for future entries.

Reflections/Notes: Record additional notes.
